



Artis X8 5.1

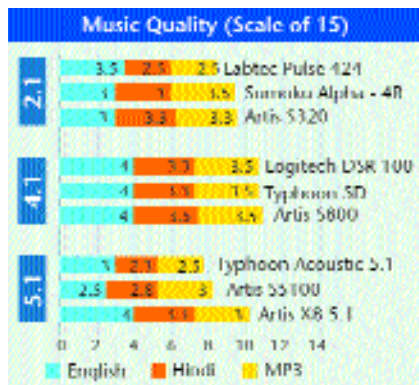
Sporting a black finish, the first thing that strikes you with this speaker system is its enormous subwoofer. This speaker system has six discrete channels of input and is therefore ideally suited to a Dolby Digital setup. With adequate documentation and a quick setup guide, setting up this speaker system is a simple task. The long cables ensure that there is adequate room for setting up the speakers. Additionally, there is also an infrared remote control provided for controlling volume, mute, bass and treble settings. The front of the subwoofer has soft-touch controls for main volume, bass, etc. The panel

also features an LED indicator for displaying sound setup. It is priced at Rs 12,000 and if power is what you're looking for, this speaker system definitely fits the bill.

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Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Warranty & support	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶

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to complain. Even at 80 per cent volume level, the overall sound quality was good and the bass didn't sound flat. However, the vocals sounded a little overpowering while playing Audio CDs. Another area where the speaker was found to be slightly lacking was in the

reproduction of high frequency sounds. This however, was remedied with equalisation through the audio playback software.

Special audio test: A good set of speakers should be capable of playing different types of sound as they are going to be used for everything ranging from movies to different genres of music. To evaluate these parameters, we used a special CD that contained a variety of such sounds across 17 audio tracks.

Among the 2.1 speakers, the Mercury SW-980 should get a worthy mention here as it was able to reproduce different background effects such as the chirping of a bird or nuances like breathing noises during songs. The Artis S400 also exhibited good characteristics here—it produced commendable audio effects ranging from gunshots to explosions and thunder. The speaker that did not perform well in this test was the Mercury SW-480. There was loss in clarity and definition while playing back certain subtle sounds.

The 4.1 speakers that stood out were the Artis S880 and the Sumoku Alpha - 7. Here the Artis S880 adequately reproduced background effects with good overall clarity. Especially impressive was the reproduction of sounds such as thunder, gunshots, etc.



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